Most common Hazards to Vet student and professionals

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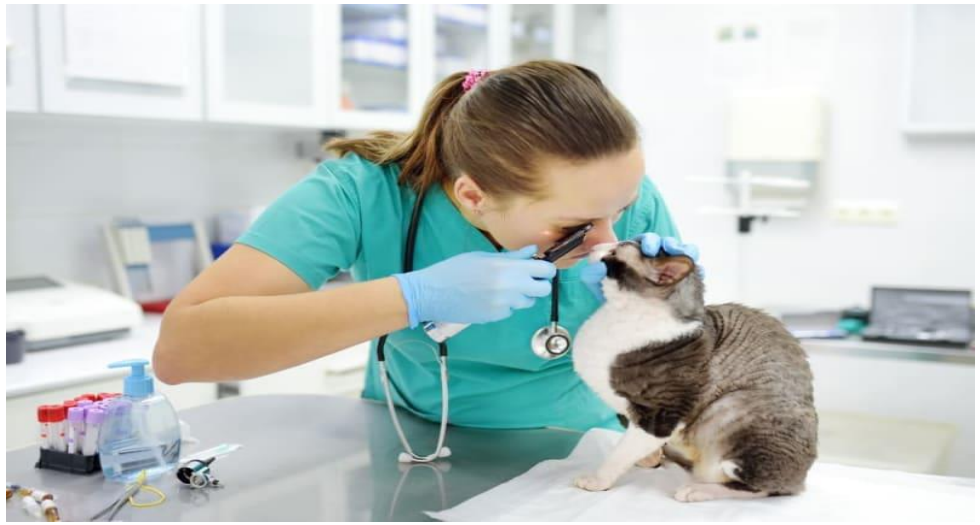
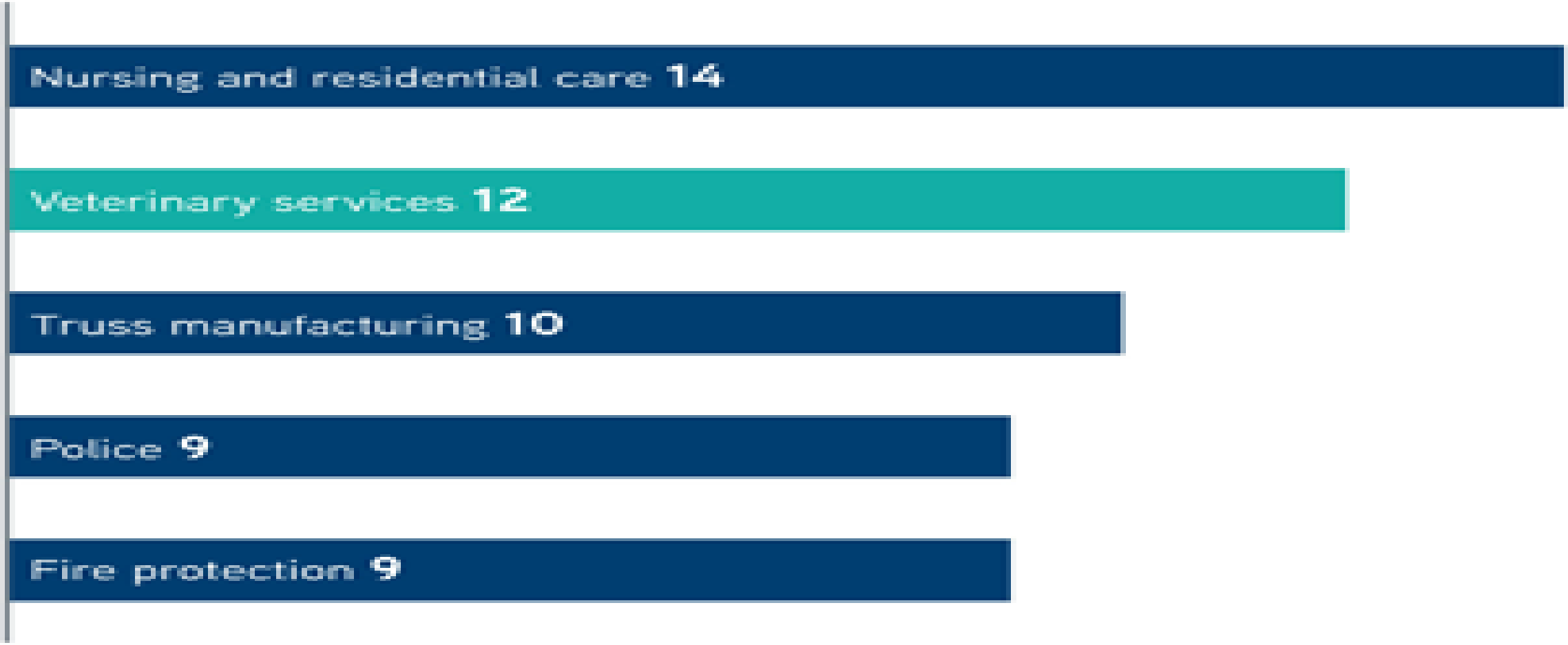
- Veterinary professionals are exposed to a range of risks that must be proactively managed: Animal-related injuries: Bites, scratches, and kicks from frightened or aggressive animals are among the most common causes of workplace injury.



- The most common injuries in veterinary practices are caused by animal-inflicted incidents, specifically bites, scratches, kicks, and crushes. These injuries, often categorized as "struck by" events, are frequent due to handling distressed or agitated animals. Additionally, slips, trips, and falls, along with strains from lifting heavy animals, are major causes of injury.

RATES OF OCCUPATIONAL INJURIES IN VARIOUS PROFESSIONS, PER 100 WORKERS, 2016



Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics

Animal Contact (Bites/Scratches/Kicks):

- Up to 2/3 veterinarians and nearly all veterinary technicians are injured by animals at some point in their careers.

Musculoskeletal Disorders (MSDs):

- Strains and sprains are highly common, often resulting from lifting, restraining, or treating animals, particularly affecting the back, shoulders, and arms.

Slips, Trips, and Falls:

- Wet floors, spills, and cluttered, fast-paced environments are frequent, causing injuries to staff and sometimes clients.

Sharps Injuries:

- Needle-stick and scalpel blade accidents are frequently reported among veterinary staff.

Equipment/Hazardous Material:

- Injuries also occur from handling heavy equipment or exposure to chemicals and anesthesia gases

Hierarchy of Controls

Source: CDC NIOSH

Who Is More Likely To Be Injured at Work: A Firefighter or a VetTech?

VetTechPrep

A **safe** workplace is **sound** business